

WOLFE

BY DORIAN WOLFE

DATE GUIDE

FIRST DATE BLUEPRINT

Where to go, what to say, how to read the room,
and how to end it well. A calm plan for your first
date.

DORIAN WOLFE · CALM. DIRECT. REAL.

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Dorian Wolfe shares general communication advice for adults. It is not therapy and no result is guaranteed. Always respect other people's boundaries and consent.

STEP 1

PICK THE RIGHT DATE

The best first date is short, public and easy to leave or extend.

Coffee or a walk Low pressure, great for talking. 60 to 90 minutes.

A quiet bar or cafe Slightly more relaxed. Avoid loud places where you cannot hear.

Avoid Movies (no talking), long dinners (too much commitment), your home.

PICK A PLACE YOU KNOW

Choose somewhere you have been, close to her, and easy to find. Confirm the time and place the day before.

Looking forward to tomorrow. [Place] at [time]. See you there. 😊

Day-before text

STEP 2

PREPARE (30 MINUTES)

- Clean, fitted clothes that make you feel good.
- Grooming: haircut, nails, fresh breath.
- Arrive 5 to 10 minutes early. Never late.
- Phone on silent. Charged. Put away.
- Two stories you can tell in 30 seconds.
- Three questions you can ask (see Playbook chapter 4).
- Know your budget and offer to pay or split gracefully.

MINDSET

The goal is not to impress her. The goal is to find out whether you two genuinely enjoy each other.

STEP 3

THE FIRST 5 MINUTES

Nerves peak in the first five minutes. Make them easy:

Smile and greet

Eye contact, a warm "Hi [Name], great to meet you." Offer a brief hug or handshake if comfortable.

Compliment once

"You look great" is enough. Keep it simple and sincere.

Ease in

Talk about the place, the journey, something light.

Hi [Name], great to finally meet you. Did you find this place okay?

I picked this spot because [reason]. I hope you like it.

STEP 4

WHAT TO TALK ABOUT

Aim for a mix of light and meaningful. Good topics:

- Travel: best trip, next trip.
- Food and places she loves.
- Hobbies and things she is passionate about.

15 QUESTIONS

- 1 What is the best part of your week so far?
- 2 What do you do when you want to switch off?
- 3 What is the best meal you have ever had?
- 4 Where would you go if you could leave tomorrow?
- 5 What are you most proud of this year?
- 6 What is something you are curious about?
- 7 What made you laugh recently?
- 8 What do you enjoy about your work?
- 9 What kind of music do you actually listen to?
- 10 What was your favourite thing about growing up?
- 11 What are you looking forward to?
- 12 What is a perfect weekend for you?
- 13 Do you have a hobby that surprised people?
- 14 What is your most useless talent?
- 15 What matters most to you in life?

✗ Avoid: ex-partners, money problems, politics rants, complaining.

STEP 5

ANSWERING "TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF"

Use Present, Past, Passion and keep it under 30 seconds.

I work in [field], which I got into by accident. I grew up in [place], so I am a little obsessed with [thing]. Lately I have been getting into [hobby]. Your turn, how about you?

BE REAL

Do not exaggerate. Honesty builds trust and saves awkward moments later.

STEP 6

BODY LANGUAGE BASICS

Eye contact	Look at her while she speaks. Break away naturally.
Posture	Sit relaxed, shoulders back, uncrossed arms.
Phone	Out of sight. Never check it.
Voice	Slow down. Nervous people speak fast.
Listening	Nod, smile, react. Do not interrupt.

STEP 7

THE BILL AND READING INTEREST

THE BILL

Let me get this one.

If you want to pay

Shall we split it? Next one is on me.

If she offers to split

Do not argue or make it awkward. Be gracious either way.

SIGNS SHE IS ENJOYING IT

- She asks you questions back.
- She laughs, smiles and stays engaged.
- She turns her body toward you and keeps eye contact.
- She suggests extending the date or seeing you again.

WHEN YOU CANNOT TELL

I am having a really good time. How about you?

Ask directly. Honesty is attractive.

STEP 8

ENDING THE DATE

End while it is still going well. Be clear and warm.

I really enjoyed this. I would like to see you again. Would you like that?

If you want a second date

I had a nice time. I do not think we are a match, but I enjoyed meeting you.

If you do not feel it

CONSENT MATTERS

For a hug or a kiss, read her body language and ask: "Can I kiss you?" A respectful yes is better than a guess. Accept a no with a smile.

STEP 9

AFTER THE DATE

Message within 24 hours. Do not play games or wait three days.

I had a great time tonight. Thanks for coming. Let us do it again soon. 😊

If you want another date

Got home safe? I really enjoyed meeting you.

Caring and light

Thanks for meeting me. I do not think there was a spark for me, but I wish you the best.

If you are not interested

If she is not interested, accept it. You still gained practice.

BONUS 1

25 FIRST DATE IDEAS

Short, public, easy to enjoy. Pick one that suits both of you.

- 1 Coffee and a walk in a nice park.
- 2 A local market or street-food tour.
- 3 A museum or gallery visit.
- 4 A cosy bookshop and hot chocolate.
- 5 A quiet cafe with board games.
- 6 A sunset walk by the water.
- 7 A casual brunch.
- 8 A small live-music night.
- 9 A pottery or cooking drop-in class.
- 10 Mini golf or bowling.
- 11 An ice cream and a stroll.
- 12 A farmers market and picnic.
- 13 A scenic viewpoint with coffee.
- 14 A food-truck lunch.
- 15 A botanical garden.
- 16 A rooftop drink at sunset.
- 17 A quiet wine or mocktail bar.
- 18 An arcade evening.
- 19 A zoo or aquarium visit.
- 20 A flea market hunt.
- 21 A trivia or quiz night.

22 A local festival.

23 A hike (easy trail) with a coffee stop.

24 A dessert tasting.

25 A walk plus a small gallery.

RULE

Choose something that gives you things to talk about (a place, a view, a task) so conversation feels natural.

BONUS 2

LOOK AND FEEL YOUR BEST

Clothes	Clean, well-fitting and appropriate for the place. Wear what makes you comfortable.
Hair and grooming	Fresh haircut or tidy beard, clean nails.
Smell	Light fragrance, fresh breath.
Shoes	Clean. People notice.
Sleep	Aim for a good night before. Tired people are less fun.
Eat lightly	Avoid garlic-heavy or very heavy meals beforehand.

DAY-OF CHECKLIST

- ☐ Confirmed time and place.
- ☐ Phone charged.
- ☐ Cash or card ready.
- ☐ Arrive 10 minutes early.
- ☐ Two stories ready.
- ☐ Three questions ready.
- ☐ Told a friend where I am going.

BONUS 3

A DATE, MINUTE BY MINUTE

0-5 min	Greet warmly, compliment once, ease in with the place or journey.
5-20 min	Light topics: travel, food, week. Use Echo, Dig, Share.
20-45 min	Go warmer: passions, growing up, goals. Share your own too.
45-60 min	Check the mood. If good, extend or plan the next one.
60-90 min	End on a high. Do not outstay the good part.

SCRIPT FOR EXTENDING

I am enjoying this. Do you want to grab a bite or walk a bit more?

SCRIPT FOR ENDING

I have to head off, but I loved this. I would like to see you again.

BONUS 4

HANDLING COMMON DATE PROBLEMS

She is late	Message once, relax, read a book. Do not complain when she arrives.
Awkward silence	Use a callback or an observation. See the Playbook.
She is quiet	Ask easy questions and share more yourself. Do not push.
You are nervous	Tell her. "I am a bit nervous." It often relaxes both of you.
Wrong spark	Be kind, finish the date politely, and be honest afterwards.
She seems uncomfortable	Slow down, give space, ask if she wants to end early.
Money awkwardness	Offer to pay, or split gracefully. No scenes.

BONUS 5

THE SECOND DATE

The second date is where you get to know the person beyond the first-impression layer.

Do something different

A new activity, not just another coffee.

Go deeper

Move to Layer 2 and 3 questions, sharing your own.

Be consistent

Be the same person you were on date one.

Talk about future plans lightly

Ask about her next few weeks.

Check in

"How are you finding this so far?"

I had a great time on our first date. Want to try [activity] this weekend?

Invite for the second

WORKSHEET

DATE REVIEW

WHAT I ENJOYED

WHAT I LEARNED ABOUT HER

WHAT I WOULD DO DIFFERENTLY

WOULD I SEE HER AGAIN?

SAFETY

STAY SAFE, STAY KIND

- Meet in public, arrive and leave separately for the first dates.
- Tell a friend where you are going.
- Trust your gut. Leave if something feels off.
- Limit alcohol. Keep your own drink in sight.
- Respect her boundaries. No means no.

10 FIRST-DATE MISTAKES

- ✗ Being late or cancelling last minute.
- ✗ Talking only about yourself.
- ✗ Checking your phone.
- ✗ Complaining about your ex.
- ✗ Trying too hard to impress.
- ✗ Heavy topics too early.
- ✗ Drinking too much.
- ✗ Interrupting.
- ✗ Ignoring signs she is uncomfortable.
- ✗ Pushing for more when she says no.

Want to keep the conversation flowing all night? Get **The Conversation Playbook**.

BE CALM.
BE CURIOUS.
BE REAL.

— Dorian Wolfe